[METRIC]
A-A-2893
November 15, 1994

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PAD, WRITING, LEATHERETTE BINDING

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description for all Federal Agencies.

1. Scope. This description covers writing pads in three sizes, made with an artificial leatherette binding.

2. Salient Characteristics.
2.1 Material. The paper shall be white and made from not less than 95% bleached chemical pulp.

2.2 Workmanship. All edges of the paper shall be smoothly and evenly cut. Paper shall be free from holes, tears, wrinkles, dirt, foreign matter, or other defects.

2.3 Physical Requirements of Paper

Table I

Characteristic	Requirement	Tappi Test Method
Basis Weight avg. g/m2 (lbs, 17x22-500) +/- 5%	60 (16)	T410
Bursting strength, kpa avg.,min. (psi)	83 (12)	T807
Thickness, mm, +/- 0.012mm (inch,+/-0.0005 inch)	0.07 (0.0030)	T411
Opacity, percent, min.	75	T425

2.3.1 Writing quality. Paper shall be sufficiently sized to accept fountain pen ink writing without feathering or ink penetration through to the opposite side of the sheet when tested as follows. Draw several lines and characters on both surfaces of the paper with a medium point (commercial type) fountain pen using a one (1) percent aqueous solution of either C.I. Acid Red 1 (Color Index No. 18050) or C.I. Acid Green 8 (Color Index No. 42085). To be considered satisfactory, the lines and characters shall not feather or penetrate through to the opposite side of the paper. Both surfaces of the pad paper shall be sized or otherwise processed to provide good erasability. Good erasability of the paper surface shall be determined as follows. Draw several lines and characters with a No. 2 1/2 lead pencil and erase with a latex rubber eraser; on the same area, redraw pencil lines or

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FSC 7530

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characters and erase. The tested area shall not show smearing of the pencil lines, or failure of the paper fiber.

2.3.2 Color. The pad sheets shall be white, and all of the same color.

2.4 Backing. The pad backing shall be chipboard or other suitable paperboard which shall conform to Table II.

Table II

Characteristic	Requirement	Tappi Test Method
Thickness, min.,mm (inch)	1.2 (0.050)	T411
Bursting strength, avg.min. kpa (psi)	413 (60)	T807

2.5 Size. The pads shall be 12.7 x 20.3 cm (5x8 inch), 21.6 x 29.8 cm (8 1/2 x 11 3/4 inch), or 21.6 x 35.6 cm (8 1/2 x 14 inch) as specified in the ordering data. A tolerance of +/-0.3 cm (+/- 1/8 inch) in each direction shall be permitted. The first dimension given is the horizontal dimension.

2.6 Rulings. The sheets shall be ruled on both sides and conform to the following spacings: Lines shall be spaced 0.8 cm (5/16 inch) apart with a tolerance of +/- 0.1 cm (+/- 1/16 inch). The first line shall begin not less than 2.7 cm (1 1/16 inch) nor more than 3.6 cm (1 7/16 inch) from the perforation on the front side and from the bottom of the back side of the paper. The unlined portion of the front side of the sheet shall be located at the binding end of the sheet, and the unlined portion of the back side of the sheet shall be located at the end opposite the binding end.

There shall be 1 or 2 vertical rulings extending the full length of the sheet. For size 12.7 x 20.3 cm (5x8 inch) pads, the ruling nearest the left edge shall be located 2.5 +/- 0.3 cm (1 inch, +/- 1/8 inch) from the left edge of the sheet. For other sizes, the ruling nearest the left edge shall be located 3.2 cm,+0.4,-0.3 cm (1 1/4 inch, + 3/16, -1/8 inch) from the left edge of the paper. The width between the lines shall not exceed 0.3 cm(1/8 inch).

2.7 Ink. The ruling ink shall be blue, except that the vertical ruling shall be red. The ruling shall be continuous and uniform without waviness or feathering of the lines.

2.8 Assembly of pads. Each pad shall contain no less than 50 sheets. The sheets shall have a backing sheet of equal size, +/- 0.1 cm (+/- 1/16inch) and a front reinforcing strip of the same material. The front reinforcing strip shall run the full width of the pad and shall extend 1.9 cm, +/- 0.1 cm (3/4inch, +/- 1/16inch) from the top edge of the pad. A minimum of two staples shall fasten together the front reinforcing strip, sheets and backing sheet. A brown, leatherette (artificial leather) binding strip of non-woven coated paper, stamped in gold colored foil with the word "SKILCRAFT" and a recycled logo, shall be firmly adhered to the backing, top edge and reinforcing strip. The binding strip shall cover the front reinforcing strip, plus 0.8 mm (1/32 inch), minus 0.1 cm (1/16inch) and shall extend and cover the full width of the backing sheet for a distance of not less than 1.3 cm (1/2inch) from the top edge. The binding strip shall be attached with a suitable adhesive.

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The sheets shall be perforated across the width of the pad. The perforations shall be parallel to the bottom edge of the reinforcing strip and shall not fall under the strip nor be located beyond the bottom edge of the strip by more than 0.1 cm (1/16inch).

2.9 Padding strength. Hold the pad to be tested in a stationary, vertical position with the padded edge down. While holding the backing, allow the sheet pad to naturally fall until it hangs supported by the padding, without twisting or jerking the backing. Repeat the test three additional times. The pads of sheets shall not become detached from the pad backing nor separated for more than one inch along the padded edge.

2.10 Binding quality and strength. Remove five (5) sheets, one sheet at a time, from the pad. Examine the torn edge of the sheets. The edge shall not be ripped with ragged edges, but shall have a clean and straight edge. Sheets shall be able to be removed with reasonable effort. Fold at least five (5) sheets over and under the pad and press the fold slightly. Examine the sheets and binding at the fold. The sheets shall not break, split, or separate from the binding of the pad.

3. Bleaching. To obtain an acceptable brightness a chemical bleaching process may be used. When specified in the ordering data, the bleaching process shall not include the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, hypochlorite, or other chlorine containing compound. Certification of compliance shall be made available upon request by the Government.

4. Regulatory Requirements. The contractor shall certify that the minimum content standard shall be no less than 50% recovered materials including 20% postconsumer materials in accordance with Executive Order 12873, section 504 (b), dated October 20, 1993 (See definition of postconsumer materials and recovered materials in sections 203 and 205). As an alternative to meeting the standards of section 504(b) for all printing and writing papers, the minimum content standard shall be no less than 50% recovered materials that are a waste material byproduct of a finished product other than a paper or textile product which would otherwise be disposed of in a landfill, as determined by the State in which the facility is located, in accordance with Executive Order 12873, section 504 (c), dated October 20, 1993. The pad backing offered shall include a minimum of 90% postconsumer recovered materials, in accordance with CFR 40 Part 250. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.1 Labeling. The recycled content shall be marked on the product or unit pack.

5. Quality Assurance Provisions.
5.1 Inspection.
5.1.1 Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

5.1.2 Responsibility for Inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all the inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the contractor may

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utilize his own facilities or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government.

Sampling for examination and tests shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, using the plans specified in Table III, unless otherwise stated. For the purposes of sampling for end item testing, a lot shall consist of pads submitted for inspection at one time. Unless otherwise specified, the sample unit shall be one pad. Unless otherwise specified, every lot shall be tested. There shall be no failures to meet requirements.

Table III

Examine	Inspection Level	AQL (% defect)/ acceptance
Workmanship/general	S-3	4.0
Dimensions/assembly	S-4	2.5
Physical Requirements	S-2 (1)	2.5 (1)

(1) Tappi tests shall be in accordance with Tappi T400 for the applicable Tappi test methods.

6. Packaging, Packing, and Marking. Packaging, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. Applicable Documents and Document Sources. The following documents form a part of the Commercial Item Description to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:
(1) Tappi Standards are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, P.O. Box 105113, Atlanta, GA 30348.
(2) MIL-STD-105 is available from Standardization Documents Order Desk, Bldg. 4D, 700 Robbins Ave., Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.
(3) Executive Order 12873 is available from The White House Publications Office, New Executive Office Building, White House, Att: Publications, Washington, D.C. 20500. Phone (202) 395-7332.
(4) The Code of Federal Regulations, Title 40, Protection of Environment, Part 250 may be purchased from the Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402. Phone (202)783-3238. When ordering, ask for: Title 40, Parts 190-250; Stock Number: 869-013-00-146-0.
(5) Copies of Commercial Item Descriptions, federal standards or specifications are available from: Federal Supply Service Bureau, Specification Section (3FPB-W), Suite 8100, 470 East L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.

8. Ordering Data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:
1. Title, number and date of the Commercial Item Description
2. Size
3. If non-chlorine bleaching is required
4. Packaging, packing and marking

MILITARY INTEREST:
NONE: DOD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
GSA-FSS

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